

5. Project Development Phase

- The Project Development Phase is the implementation stage where the planned spreadsheet import process is actually configured. This phase converts the project design into a working solution.

- The development process begins with preparing the spreadsheet. The spreadsheet should contain appropriate column headers and valid data. Empty rows and unnecessary columns should be removed. Data should be standardized wherever possible. For example, department names should follow a consistent format, and dates should use an acceptable format.

- The spreadsheet is then imported into the system using the appropriate import functionality. The imported data is generally stored in an Import Set table or staging table. This table acts as an intermediate location between the spreadsheet and the final target table.

- After the source data is available, the Transform Map is created. The Transform Map specifies the target table into which the imported data will be transferred. Source fields are then mapped to corresponding target fields.

For example:

Source: Employee ID → Target: Employee ID

Source: Employee Name → Target: Name

Source: Email → Target: Email

Source: Department → Target: Department

Source: Location → Target: Location

- If the source and target values need modification, transformation logic can be applied. For example, if a spreadsheet contains a department code instead of the complete department name, a transformation rule can convert the code into the required value.

- A coalesce field can also be configured when duplicate detection or record updating is required. If Employee ID is unique, it can be used as the identifying field. When a matching Employee ID already exists, the system can update the existing record rather than creating another record.

- The developer should also configure appropriate error handling. Records with invalid values should be identified so that they can be corrected. Import logs and transformation results should be reviewed after each test import.

- Development should initially be performed using a small sample dataset. After the sample data is successfully transformed, a larger dataset can be tested. This reduces the possibility of

introducing a large number of incorrect records into the target table.